In September of 2012, Aung San Suu Kyi arrived in the United States for a three-week stay. During her visit, Suu Kyi stopped in Washington, D.C., New York, Indiana, Kentucky, Massachusetts, and California. Her most pressing engagements were the stops in Washington, D.C. and New York. During her visit, President Thein Sein was also in the United States for the opening session of the United Nations.

While in Washington, D.C., Suu Kyi was given the Congressional Gold Medal that was awarded in absentia in 2008. She also met with President Barack Obama and congressional leaders. Her trip to Washington, D.C., ended with a speech before a gathering of activists from Amnesty International.

In a sort of homecoming, Suu Kyi returned to New York. She had previously lived there in the 1960s when she worked for the UN. During her visit to the city, she also visited Burmese immigrants and spoke to students at Columbia University and Queens College. Suu Kyi continually stressed the confidence she placed in the new Myanmar leadership and encouraged Western businesses to invest in the country. In all her speeches, Aung San Suu Kyi emphasized the importance of freedom and human rights.

The current administration is actively consulting with Aung San Suu Kyi concerning the steps being taken to restore the public image of her father. His former headquarters are being restored and his mausoleum is being opened for longer periods of time. Some analysts worry that too much of the focus has been placed on the two key individuals: Aung San Suu Kyi and Thein Sein. This concern seems legitimate because the political change has in many ways been a personality-driven process. Neither leader has a clear successor and both have some health concerns, which at some point will create difficulty.

THE LOOMING PROBLEM: ETHNIC RELATIONS IN MYANMAR

The most pressing concern for the future development of Myanmar both economically and politically is the resolution of the ethnic problem. Issues such as regional autonomy, economic empowerment, sustainable peace, and